

Metr Backend — Recent Changes (Oct 2026)

Audience: frontend, QA, stakeholders
Date: 5 October 2026
Services: user-service (:3000) · content-service (:3001)
Postman: postman/Metr-API.postman_collection.json
Full API contract: docs/Metr-Frontend-API-Guide.md / .pdf

This note covers the work from the last few days. Errors are bilingual:

```
{ "error": "CODE", "message": { "en": "...", "ar": "..." } }
```

1. Account Recovery (guest) — content-service

Manual recovery only. Guest proves phone ownership with OTP, then submits a Contact Us ticket of type **Account Recovery**. Support reviews offline — **no auto-restore API**.

Flow

- 1. Guest taps **Recover Account** (login / help) — frontend only; hide when logged in
- 2. Contact Us opens with type locked to ACCOUNT_RECOVERY
- 3. Enter mobile → OTP SMS (or content-service console if 4Jawaly empty)
- 4. Verify 6-digit OTP
- 5. Write message → Submit
- 6. Thank-you + ticket id for support

OTP rules (same as auth)

Rule	Value
Length	6 digits
TTL	2 minutes
Max wrong attempts	3 → lock 5 minutes
Resend cooldown	30 seconds
Max resends	3 per session

Contact type

ACCOUNT_RECOVERY — labels: **Account Recovery** / استرجاع الحساب

APIs

Start OTP

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/contact/recovery/otp/start \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d "{\"phone\":\"+96651234567\"}"
```

201

```
{
  "sessionId": "uuid",
  "expiresAt": "...",
  "resendAvailableAt": "...",
  "attemptsRemaining": 3
}
```

Verify OTP

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/contact/recovery/otp/verify \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d "{\"sessionId\":\"SESSION_ID\",\"code\":\"123456\"}"
```

201 { "sessionId": "uuid", "verified": true, "phone": "+96651234567" }

Error	HTTP
OTP_INVALID	400 + attemptsRemaining
OTP_EXPIRED	400
OTP_LOCKED	429 + lockedUntil
SESSION_NOT_FOUND	404

Resend OTP

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/contact/recovery/otp/resend \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d "{\"sessionId\":\"SESSION_ID\"}"
```

Submit recovery ticket

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/contact \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d "
{
  \"type\": \"ACCOUNT_RECOVERY\",
  \"phone\": \"+96651234567\",
  \"sessionId\": \"SESSION_ID\",
  \"message\": \"I deleted my account by mistake and want it back please.\",
  \"acceptedPrivacy\": true
}
```

Required: type, phone, verified sessionId, message (20–256), acceptedPrivacy: true .

Optional: email, title (defaults to Account Recovery).

201 { "id": "uuid", "message": { "en", "ar" }, "followUp": { "en", "ar" } }

Error	When
RECOVERY_OTP_REQUIRED	missing <code>sessionId</code>
RECOVERY_OTP_NOT_VERIFIED	not verified / phone mismatch
CONTACT_PHONE_REQUIRED	no phone
CONTACT_RATE_LIMITED	>3 submits / 15 min

Env (content-service)

```
OTP_SECRET=...
JAWALY_API_KEY=
JAWALY_API_SECRET=
JAWALY_SENDER=
```

If Jawaly keys are empty, OTP is logged in the **content-service** terminal.

2. Follow / Following (advertisers only) — user-service

Already on the API. Summary for handoff:

- Flag: `isAdvertiser` (default `false` on signup)
- Follow only advertisers → else `403 FOLLOW_NOT_ALLOWED`
- Search + suggested = advertisers only
- Following list = advertisers only
- Profile flags: `canFollow`, `isFollowing`, `showFollowers`, `canBeFollowed`

Curls

```
# JWT required
curl "http://localhost:3000/users/search?q=ali" -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl "http://localhost:3000/users/suggested" -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl http://localhost:3000/users/USER_ID -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl http://localhost:3000/users/USER_ID/following?limit=20&offset=0 \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl http://localhost:3000/users/USER_ID/followers?limit=20&offset=0 \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl -X POST http://localhost:3000/users/ADVERTISER_ID/follow \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
curl -X DELETE http://localhost:3000/users/ADVERTISER_ID/follow \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
```

Following list item shape (for Unfollow UI):

```
{
  "id": "uuid",
  "username": "agent1",
  "displayName": "Ali Ahmed",
  "photoUrl": "/uploads/...",
  "isAdvertiser": true,
  "followingCount": 3500,
  "isFollowing": true,
  "canFollow": false
}
```

Empty Following list → frontend empty state (“You’re not following any advertisers yet” + Find advertisers).

Not built: Following posts feed, video Follow CTAs, upgrade/downgrade advertiser API.

3. Combined docs & Postman

One collection and one frontend guide for **both** services:

File	Use
postman/Metr-API.postman_collection.json	Import in Postman
docs/Metr-Frontend-API-Guide.md	Full contract (AI-friendly)
docs/Metr-Frontend-API-Guide.pdf	Printable handoff

Folders: User Service (auth, profile, follows) · Content Service (About/Help/Version/Languages/Contact + recovery OTP + admin CMS).

Happy path: Sign up → paste OTP from **user-service** console → Verify → Me / Content / Recovery.

4. Normal Contact Us (unchanged + recovery type)

```
curl http://localhost:3001/contact/types
curl -X POST http://localhost:3001/contact \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"phone":"+96651234567","title":"Cannot login","type":"ACCOUNT_ISSUE","message":"I cannot sign in with my phone number today.","acceptedPrivacy":true}'
```

Types include: FEEDBACK , BUG_REPORT , FEATURE_REQUEST , ACCOUNT_ISSUE , OTHER , ACCOUNT_RECOVERY .

5. Auth reminder (user-service)

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:3000/auth/signup \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d "{\"phone\":\"+96651234567\",\"username\":\"Murabaa-1837\",\"acceptedTerms\":true}"

curl -X POST http://localhost:3000/auth/otp/verify \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d "{\"sessionId\":\"SESSION_ID\",\"code\":\"123456\"}"

curl http://localhost:3000/auth/me -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN"
```

Not in this release

- Video upload / feed / Scylla timeline
- Search videos by username or city (Elasticsearch)
- Media storage ticket (S3/etc.) — awaiting assignment
- Auto account restore after recovery
- Advertiser role upgrade/downgrade HTTP API

Quick test checklist

1. content-service health: `GET :3001/health`
2. Recovery OTP start → console code → verify → `POST /contact` `ACCOUNT_RECOVERY`
3. Wrong OTP → `OTP_INVALID`; 3 fails → `OTP_LOCKED`
4. user-service: signup/login OTP still works
5. Follow advertiser OK; follow normal user → `FOLLOW_NOT_ALLOWED`
6. Search returns advertisers only